



Nintendo Switch Analytics

The new update to the Nintendo Switch enables Google Analytics by default - but it can be switched off. <http://dgit.in/mar21-59>



JioPhone 2021

The 2021 JioPhone offer was announced - includes 2 years of unlimited data and phone for '1999. <http://dgit.in/mar21-60>

Linksys Velop MX5 AX Wi-Fi 6 Mesh Router System

For a robust Wi-Fi 6 network

Aside from the higher data rates which are expected with each new Wi-Fi revision, Wi-Fi 6 also brings higher client capacity and improved performance in densely populated areas which have way too many Wi-Fi or other radio devices. The Linksys Velop MX5 is one of the first Wi-Fi 6 devices that we've tested and being a Velop unit, it's also part of their whole home mesh router family. Let's take a look at what all it brings to the table.

Features

The Linksys Velop MX5 has a cumulative bandwidth of 5300 Mbps which is broken up across three bands as follows - 1147 (2.4 GHz) + 2402 (5 GHz) + 1733 (5 GHz) Mbps. We've tested other

Velop devices in the past and they've used one of the bands as a backhaul so that inter-node communication always gets priority. Previously, the backhaul used to be dedicated but with the Velop MX5, they've switched to a dynamic backhaul system in which either of the 5 GHz bands can become the backhaul.

All bands support 4T4R MU-MIMO and there are a total of 12 transmission channels. This tells us that the MX5 is based on the Qualcomm Networking Pro 1200 platform which is the top-tier solution from Qualcomm. One would have high hopes from such a device.

Build Quality

The unit is built like a rock and that's something we've seen with most Linksys units that we've tested so far. The node is quite large in size and a look inside tells us that Linksys have



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tried to make the most of whatever space they had access to. There's a plastic chassis on the inside onto which all the antennae and the PCBs are mounted. The MX5

relies on passive cooling as evidenced by the massive heatsinks and the tower structure allows it to channel hot air upwards. This also adds quite a bit of heft to the device and that helps keep it stable if you have all the Ethernet cables plugged in. The USB port is adjacent to the Ethernet ports and you might have some difficulty plugging in external storage devices if the WAN port right next to it is populated. External drives with cables should fit fine.

Lastly, there's a status LED on the top which is well-hidden but not completely obscured.

Performance

The inter LAN speeds were pretty good and peaked at 951 Mbps. We used a laptop with an Intel AX200 Wi-Fi 6 card to test the speeds out. Unfortunately, the AX200 is a 2T2R card with support for 160 MHz and

the Linksys MX5 has the 5 GHz band with 4T4R MU-MIMO and supports 80 MHz streams. This limits the 5 GHz band to half of its 2402 theoretical cap and we managed to hit close to 752 Mbps on the uplink and downlink with the 5 GHz band. This was with the router placed within 5 meters of the endpoint. Moving the endpoint to about 15 meters from the router with a clear line of sight brought the download speed down to 636 Mbps but the upload speed dropped down to a much lower 472 Mbps mark.

In real world tests that involved reading and writing to a RAID 0 NAS connected via LAN showed similar numbers to the inter LAN benchmarks. We also played a little bit of Valorant and CS:GO with the Linksys Velop MX5 as the intermediary. It didn't add much to our latency times. Local Mumbai Valorant servers were pinging at 11-12 milliseconds and CS:GO was pinging at 5-6 milliseconds. Compared to our previous pings without the Velop MX5, this was just an addition of 1-2 milliseconds.

Verdict

The Linksys Velop MX5 is a pretty robust Wi-Fi 6 whole home mesh system. It's built really well and the UI within the admin panel is pretty encompassing given what all you can tinker with. Speeds were also at par with the drop-off over distance being a little higher for the upload speeds than what we've seen with some Wi-Fi 5 routers.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

MODEL: MX5300-AH | WI-FI: 802.11ax | LAN: 4x 10/100/1000 Gbit | WAN: 10/100/1000 Gbit | USB: 3.0 Port | SOC: IPQ8072A | WLAN: QCA8075 | DIMENSIONS: 11.4 x 11.4 x 24.4 cms | WEIGHT: 1.6 kg | WARRANTY: 3 - years.

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